

Word family: **trouble / troubles / troubled / troubling / troublesome**

Base word: trouble

Plural: troubles

Past tense: troubled

Past participle: troubled

** -ing form:** troubling

Related form: troublesome

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “I still remember one time when I forgot to bring my homework and thought I was going to get into serious **trouble**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **trouble** means a **difficult or unpleasant situation, especially one involving punishment or criticism because you have done something wrong**.

The speaker thought forgetting his homework might lead to punishment from the teacher.

繁體中文：**因做錯事、違反規則或出現問題而可能受到責備、處罰或陷入困境的情況；麻煩 / 惹麻煩**

中文翻譯：

> “...thought I was going to get into serious **trouble**.”

「.....以為自己會**惹上大麻煩 / 受到嚴厲責備或處罰**。」

Here:

get into trouble = 因做錯事或出現問題而陷入麻煩、受到責備或處罰

1. **trouble = problems / difficulties (問題 / 困難) — 麻煩；困難；問題**

This is the broad central noun meaning.

Meaning: Problems, difficulties, or unpleasant situations that make something hard to deal with.

Practice 1

> “We had some **trouble** finding the address.”

「我們找那個地址時遇到了一些**困難 / 麻煩**。」

Practice 2

> “The car has been giving us a lot of **trouble** lately.”

「這部車最近給我們帶來很多**麻煩 / 問題**。」

****trouble = 令人感到困難、不順利或需要處理的問題****

Common:

- * have trouble doing something
- * cause trouble
- * financial trouble
- * technical trouble
- * relationship trouble

These belong to one broad ****problem/difficulty**** sense.

2. ****be/get in trouble (做錯事 / 處罰) — 惹麻煩 ; 有麻煩 ; 受責備 / 處罰****

This is the exact use in your passage.

****Meaning:**** To be in a situation where you may be criticized, punished, or face negative consequences because of something you have done.

Practice 3 — Original

> “I thought I was going to get into serious ****trouble****.”

「我以為自己會****惹上大麻煩 / 受到嚴厲處罰****。」

Practice 4

> “He got into ****trouble**** for breaking the school rules.”

「他因違反校規而****惹上麻煩 / 受到處罰****。」

Practice 5

> “You’ll be in ****trouble**** if the teacher finds out.”

「如果老師發現，你就會**有麻煩 / 被責備**。」

****be/get in trouble = 因做錯事、違反規則或造成問題而面臨責備、處罰或其他不良後果****

This is very common and learner-important.

For strict core counting, I would keep it under the broader ****problem/difficulty**** noun sense, but display it separately because its grammar and learner meaning are distinctive.

3. ****trouble = danger / serious difficulty (危險 / 困境) — 困境 ; 危險****

****Trouble**** can also mean a serious difficult or dangerous situation, even when nobody has done anything wrong.

Practice 6

> “The climbers were in ****trouble**** after the weather changed.”

「天氣轉變後，登山者陷入了****困境 / 危險****。」

Practice 7

> “If the engine fails out here, we could be in real ****trouble****.”

「如果引擎在這裡壞掉，我們可能真的會陷入****大麻煩 / 危險****。」

****be in trouble = 處於困難、危險或需要幫助的情況****

Compare:

> “He is in trouble with the teacher.”

= 可能被責備 / 處罰。

> “The swimmer is in trouble.”

= 游泳者可能有危險，需要幫助。

The surrounding context determines the interpretation.

4. ****have trouble doing something (做某事有困難) — 難以 ; 有困難****

This is one of the most productive constructions.

Practice 8

> “I have **trouble remembering** names.”

「我**很難記住**別人的名字。」

Practice 9

> “She had **trouble opening** the window.”

「她**很難把窗打開 / 開窗時遇到困難**。」

have trouble + -ing = 做某件事情時感到困難，無法輕易完成

This is not a separate core lexical meaning; it belongs to **difficulty/problem**.

5. **trouble = effort / inconvenience (費事 / 麻煩) — 工夫 ; 麻煩 ; 費事**

A distinct noun use refers to the **effort or inconvenience involved in doing something**.

Practice 10

> “Thank you for going to so much **trouble**.”

「謝謝你這麼**費心 / 花這麼多工夫**。」

Practice 11

> “It’s no **trouble** at all.”

「一點也不**麻煩 / 不費事**。」

trouble = 為完成某件事情而需要付出的額外時間、工夫或不便

Common:

- * go to the trouble of doing something
- * take the trouble to do something
- * no trouble
- * save someone the trouble

This is genuinely different from an external problem.

6. **take/go to the trouble to do something (特地費心) — 特地；費心去做**

Practice 12

> “She **took the trouble to** explain everything clearly.”

「她**特地花心思**把所有事情解釋清楚。」

Practice 13

> “He **went to the trouble of** preparing a detailed guide.”

「他**費了一番工夫**準備了一份詳細指南。」

take/go to the trouble = 願意花額外時間、心力或工夫去做某件事

This belongs to Meaning 5.

7. **trouble = illness / physical problem (健康) — 毛病；疾病；不適**

Trouble can refer to a medical or physical problem.

Practice 14

> “He has had heart **trouble** for several years.”

「他患有心臟**毛病 / 疾病**多年。」

Practice 15

> “She went to the doctor because of stomach **trouble**.”

「她因為胃部**不適 / 毛病**去看醫生。」

trouble = 身體某部位或功能出現的健康問題

Common:

* heart trouble

* stomach trouble

* breathing trouble

For core counting, I would merge this with the general **problem/difficulty** meaning as a medical domain extension.

8. **troubles** = worries / difficulties in one's life (煩惱) — 煩惱；憂患

In the plural, **troubles** can mean personal worries or problems.

Practice 16

> “She told him about her **troubles**.”

「她把自己的**煩惱 / 困難**告訴了他。」

Practice 17

> “Music helped him forget his **troubles** for a while.”

「音樂讓他暫時忘記自己的**煩惱**。」

troubles = 一個人生活中令其擔憂、痛苦或困擾的各種問題

This is still part of the broad noun **problems** sense.

9. **trouble someone** = worry / disturb someone (動詞) — 使擔心；困擾

As a verb, **trouble** can mean to cause someone worry, anxiety, or emotional discomfort.

Practice 18

> “Something about his explanation **troubled** me.”

「他的解釋中有些地方令我感到**不安 / 困擾**。」

Practice 19

> “She was deeply **troubled** by what she had heard.”

「她聽到那些事情後感到非常**不安 / 憂慮**。」

trouble someone = 令某人感到擔憂、不安或心理上受到困擾

This is a major verb meaning.

10. **trouble someone = bother / inconvenience someone (打擾) — 麻煩 ; 打擾**

Trouble can also politely mean to inconvenience someone or ask them to do something.

Practice 20

> “Could I **trouble** you for a glass of water?”

「可以**麻煩你**給我一杯水嗎？」

Practice 21

> “I’m sorry to **trouble** you so late.”

「這麼晚還**打擾 / 麻煩你**，不好意思。」

trouble someone = 給某人造成不便、打擾某人，或禮貌地請求某人幫忙

This is related to the idea of **causing inconvenience**, but distinct from emotional worry.

Related form: **troubled**

Troubled has two very useful branches.

**troubled = worried / distressed (憂慮的) **

Practice 22

> “He looked deeply **troubled**.”

「他看起來非常**憂慮 / 不安**。」

troubled = 因問題、擔憂或痛苦而感到不安的

**troubled = experiencing serious problems (問題重重的) **

Practice 23

> “The company has had a **troubled** history.”

「這家公司有一段**問題重重 / 動盪的**歷史。」

Practice 24

> “They tried to help children from **troubled** families.”

「他們嘗試幫助來自**問題家庭 / 困難家庭**的兒童。」

troubled = 長期受到嚴重問題、衝突或困難影響的

Related form: **troubling**

Troubling means causing concern or worry.

Practice 25

> “The report contains some **troubling** findings.”

「報告中有一些**令人擔憂**的發現。」

Practice 26

> “That is a **troubling** sign.”

「那是一個**令人不安**的跡象。」

troubling = 令人擔心、不安或產生疑慮的

Related form: **troublesome**

Troublesome means causing difficulty, annoyance, or problems.

Practice 27

> “This is a **troublesome** problem.”

「這是一個**棘手 / 麻煩的**問題。」

Practice 28

> “The machine has been **troublesome** lately.”

「這部機器最近一直很**麻煩 / 問題很多**。」

troublesome = 容易造成麻煩、困難、煩惱或不便的

Important distinction: **trouble vs problem**

problem

is the broad neutral word for something that needs solving.

trouble

often emphasizes:

- * difficulty;
- * inconvenience;
- * unpleasant consequences;
- * worry.

> “We have a problem.”

= 有一個具體問題。

> “We’re in trouble.”

= 我們陷入麻煩 / 困境。

So they overlap, but the constructions differ substantially.

Important distinction: **trouble vs difficulty**

difficulty

focuses on something being hard to do.

trouble

is broader.

> “I had difficulty understanding it.”

≈

> “I had trouble understanding it.”

But:

> “He got into trouble at school.”

cannot normally become:

> “He got into difficulty at school.”

if the meaning is punishment for misbehaviour.

Important distinction: **trouble vs danger**

danger

specifically means the possibility of harm.

trouble

is broader and may involve:

- * danger;
- * punishment;
- * financial problems;
- * inconvenience;
- * emotional difficulty.

> “The boat is in trouble.”

may imply danger.

But:

> “I’m in trouble with my teacher.”

usually means punishment/criticism rather than physical danger.

Important distinction: **troubled vs troubling**

This adjective contrast is important.

troubled

describes the person or thing **experiencing problems or worry**.

> “a troubled student”

= 一個受到問題困擾的學生

troubling

describes something **causing worry**.

> “a troubling report”

= 一份令人擔憂的報告

So:

troubled = 感到 / 受到困擾的

troubling = 令人困擾 / 擔憂的

Important distinction: **troublesome vs troubling**

troublesome

= causing practical difficulty, annoyance, or repeated problems

> troublesome equipment

troubling

= causing concern or worry

> troubling evidence

Something can be troublesome without being emotionally alarming.

Countability note

Trouble is often **uncountable**:

> “We had trouble finding the place.”

> “He is in trouble.”

Not normally:

> “a trouble” ❌

when you simply mean one problem.

But **troubles** can be plural when referring to a person's various worries or difficulties:

> “She told me about her troubles.”

= 「她跟我談了她的各種煩惱。」

This countability distinction is useful for learners, and the Golden Manual specifically recommends noting countability where it affects natural usage.

Useful expression: **ask for trouble** — 自找麻煩

Practice 29

> “Driving that fast is **asking for trouble**.”

「開車開得那麼快根本是在**自找麻煩**。」

Practice 30

> “Ignoring the warning would be **asking for trouble**.”

「無視那個警告等於**自找麻煩**。」

ask for trouble = 做一些很可能引起問題或不良後果的事情

Useful expression: **stay out of trouble** — 避免惹麻煩

Practice 31

> “Try to **stay out of trouble**.”

「盡量**別惹麻煩**。」

Practice 32

> “He promised his parents he would stay out of **trouble**.”

「他答應父母不會再**惹事 / 惹麻煩**。」

This belongs to the punishment/problem sense.

Useful expression: **no trouble at all — 一點也不麻煩**

Practice 33

> “Thanks for helping me.”

> “It was **no trouble at all**.”

「謝謝你幫我。」

「**一點也不麻煩**。」

This belongs to the **effort/inconvenience** sense.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **trouble**

* **troubles**

* **troubled**

* **troubling**

* **troublesome**

Useful constructions include:

* be in trouble

* get into trouble

* have trouble doing something

* cause trouble

* take the trouble to

* go to the trouble of

* ask for trouble

- * stay out of trouble
- * trouble someone
- * heart trouble

The Golden Manual calls for a broad sweep of grammatical constructions and family forms while still merging uses whose underlying concept has not genuinely changed.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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trouble — problem/difficulty	令人感到困難、不順利或需要處理的問題 / 麻煩
be/get in trouble — punishment	因做錯事或違反規則而面臨責備、處罰或其他不良後果
be in trouble — serious difficulty/danger	處於困難、危險或需要幫助的情況
have trouble doing	做某事時感到困難，不能輕易完成
trouble — effort/inconvenience	為完成某件事情而需要付出的額外工夫、時間或不便
trouble — health problem	身體某部位或功能出現的疾病、不適或毛病；屬於 problem 義
trouble — verb, worry	令某人感到擔心、不安或心理上受到困擾
trouble — verb, inconvenience	打擾某人、給某人造成不便，或禮貌地請求某人幫忙
troubled	感到憂慮的，或受到嚴重問題影響的
troubling	令人擔憂、不安或產生疑慮的
troublesome	容易造成麻煩、困難、煩惱或不便的

For your original sentence

> “...thought I was going to get into serious ****trouble****.”

The exact meaning is:

****get into trouble = 因做錯事或沒有按規定做事而可能受到責備、處罰或其他不良後果****

Here, because the speaker forgot his homework:

> ****get into serious trouble****

= ****惹上大麻煩 / 可能被老師嚴厲責備或處罰****

For your database, I would count ****4 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****trouble****:

1. ****noun — problem, difficulty, or unpleasant situation****
2. ****noun — effort or inconvenience involved in doing something****

3. **verb — worry/disturb someone emotionally**

4. **verb — inconvenience or bother someone**

I would keep **be/get in trouble, have trouble doing, health trouble, troubles = worries** under #1 as important constructions/domain extensions, rather than artificially inflating the core count.